

OpenITI, ver. 2025.1.9

—Release Notes—

Persian Subcorpus

This release is the first to contain a Persian subcorpus, which currently contains 354 texts.

Manuscript and Documents Subcorpus

In addition to the new Arabic and Persian texts, this release contains a new subcorpus (OpenITI-mss) of 433 transcriptions of various hand-written materials: codices, letters, administrative documents, etc. The first batch of documentary materials comes from the Invisible East corpus (<https://www.invisible-east.org/>); these documents were written in Arabic, New Persian, Middle Persian, Bactrian, and Judaeo-Persian (Persian written in Hebrew script). First manuscript transcriptions were provided by Lorenz Nigst and Stefan Kamola. We hope to grow this part of the corpus through cooperation with libraries, research projects and other scholars.

Contrary to the texts in the Arabic and Persian subcorpus, which are identified by URIs for their authors, titles and digital versions, the texts in the manuscript corpus are identified by URIs for the collection they are held in, the material object they are on, and their transcription. Full documentation of the manuscript corpus URIs and metadata files is available at <https://github.com/OpenITI/MSS>.

Uncorrected OCR

The corpus contains a growing number of texts generated using OCR. These texts have varying error rates, and have not been corrected. They are marked as TRUE in the "uncorrected_OCR" column in the metadata so that they can be excluded where required.

Corpus Metadata

Machine-readable metadata on the current release corpus is updated and available in the `OpenITI_metadata_2025-1-9.tsv` file.

The metadata has 10 new columns in comparison to previous releases:

- `language`: comma-separated list of language codes
- `subcorpus`: “ara”, “per” or “MSS”
- `uncorrected_OCR`: TRUE or FALSE

The following new columns contain metadata that is only relevant for the manuscripts subcorpus:

- `city_ar`: Arabic-script name of the city where a manuscript collection is located
- `city_lat`: Latin-script name of the city where a manuscript collection is located
- `institution_ar`: Arabic-script name of the institution that holds the manuscript
- `institution_lat`: Latin-script name of the institution that holds the manuscript
- `shelfmark`: the institution’s shelfmark/ID number of the manuscript
- `catalog_ref`: reference to the manuscript in a catalogue
- `parts`: URI of the texts contained in the manuscript

Folder structure:

- `OpenITI_data_2025-1-9.zip`: main data folder with Author > Book > Versions structure (for the manuscript subcorpus: Location > Manuscript > Transcription structure);
- `OpenITI_metadata_2025-1-9.tsv`: metadata file, with a row for each text in the corpus;
- `OpenITI_release-notes_2025-1-9.zip`:
 - `OpenITI_release-notes_2025-1-9.pdf`: these release notes;
 - `release-notes_files_2025-1-9.zip`: tsv files that provide lists of some changes in URIs in the current release (see the description of each file in these release notes).

Corpus Statistics

Category	Stats
Number of unique book titles	9,108
Number of book authors	3,558
Number of books (all versions with unique ids)	14,107
Number of uncorrected OCRred texts ¹	760

Lengths of texts (all books/objects, including all versions)

	Number of words	Number of pages (300 w/p)
Total	2,348,893,857	7,829,647
Min.	2	1
1st Qu.	8,068	27
Median	32,976	110
Mean	166,506	556
3rd Qu.	112,842	377
Max.	10,143,752	33,813

Lengths of texts (unique books/objects, including primary versions only)

	Number of words	Number of pages (300 w/p)
Total	1,117,218,563	3,724,062
Min.	2	1
1st Qu.	6,818	23

¹ The uncorrected OCRred texts are specified as TRUE in the “uncorrected_OCR” column of the metadata file.

Median	27,215	91
Mean	117,122	391
3rd Qu.	85,060	284
Max.	10,057,104	33,524

Annotation statistics

<i>Number of annotated and vetted texts (extension .mARkdown)</i>	564
<i>Number of annotated texts (extension .completed)</i>	834
<i>Number of texts .inProgress</i>	11

Book Ids

The list of the new book ids in this version is available in the `ids.tsv` file. It includes the newly added book ids and modified ids. The URI includes the information of the new book (i.e., date, author, and book title).

Modified URIs

List of modified URIs in the current release is available in `modified_uris.tsv`. Changes typically affect such fields as year, author, and title. These changes are applied to the entire metadata of the corresponding object (ids remain unchanged). Some book IDs have been removed from the corpus:

- two book IDs were split:
 - 0384IbnCaliTanukhi.NishwarMuhadara.Masaha002964Vols was split into
 - 0384MuhassinTanukhi.NishwarMuhadara.Masaha002964VolsBK1
 - 1416CabbudShaliji.NishwarQuotes.Masaha002964VolsBK2
 - 0384IbnCaliTanukhi.NishwarMuhadara.Shamela0010275 was split into
 - 0384MuhassinTanukhi.NishwarMuhadara.Shamela0010275BK1
 - 1416CabbudShaliji.NishwarQuotes.Shamela0010275BK2
- two book IDs were changed because of errors in the ID:

- Shamela9007669 > Shamela0007669
- Shamela19Y0145334 > Sham19Y0145334
- three book IDs were removed because of text quality issues:
 - 0434AnonymousDruze.RasailHikma.EScr20102915
 - 0434MultipleDruze.RasailHikmaBK1.Kraken210830163545
 - 1450CabdCazizBarakaSakin.RajulKharab.Hindawi071961815

Annotation Update

The list of texts that have been structurally annotated or where the annotation has changed (can be tracked by the file extensions) since our previous release (version [2023.1.8](#)) is provided in `annotation_update.tsv`. This file shows URIs of texts together with their current extension, which is a part of the `local_path` field value in the metadata file.

For more information on the OpenITI mARkdown and the extensions please see [here](#).

Credits

current contributors:

- Jonathan Parkes Allen (*OCR*)
- Rida Al'Arabi (*OCR*)
- Mathew Barber (*structural annotation*)
- Osama Eshera (*OCR; AOCPII assistant director*)
- Sohail Merchant (*metadata app*)
- Matthew Miller (*OpenITI co-PI, AOCPII PI*)
- John Woodworth Mullan (*OCR*)
- Lorenz Nigst (*corpus management; structural annotation; OCR*)
- Maxim Romanov (*OpenITI co-PI; conceptual development; mARkdown*)
- Sarah Bowen Savant (*OpenITI co-PI; KITAB Project PI*)
- Masoumeh Seydi (*technical development*)
- Muhammad Taimoor Shahid Khan (*OCR*)
- Yusuf Umrethwala (*OCR*)
- Peter Verkinderen (*technical development; preparing new texts for the corpus; metadata app*)
- Shireen Zaineb (*OCR*)

past contributors:

- Maroussia Bednarkiewicz (*structural annotation*)
- Christoph Gümmer (*structural annotation*)
- Hamidreza Hakimi (*structural annotation*)
- Jonas Köpsel (*structural annotation*)
- Simon Loynes (*structural annotation*)
- Cornelia Neubauer (*structural annotation*)
- Leonie Nückell (*structural annotation*)
- Aslisho Qurboniev (*structural annotation*)
- Fatemeh Shams (*structural annotation*)
- Gowaart Van Den Bossche (*structural annotation*)
- Cornelis [Eric] Van Lit (*structural annotation*)